Prof. Alexander H.-D. Cheng
Editor-in-Chief, Engineering Analysis with Boundary Elements (Elsevier)

Date: October 18, 2026 Subject: Submission of Original Research Article

Dear Prof. Cheng and Editorial Board,

We are pleased to submit our original research manuscript entitled:

"A Stabilized Vector Nodal Meshless Method for $H(\mathbf{curl})$ 2D Electromagnetic Problems on Irregular Point Clouds"

by Renato C. Mesquita, Elson J. da Silva, Bárbara M. F. Gonçalves, and Luilly A. G. Ortiz, for consideration for publication as a regular research article in Engineering Analysis with Boundary Elements.

Context and Relevance to EABE:
Engineering Analysis with Boundary Elements is the premier international forum for advances in boundary integral techniques, mesh reduction methods, and meshless formulations. In computational electromagnetics, node-based vector meshless methods offer unique potential for modeling complex, moving, or multi-scale geometries without the remeshing and distortion bottlenecks of edge finite elements. While the original Vector Nodal Meshless Method (VNMM) achieved convergence by relying on structured background subdivisions, extending the method to unconstrained point clouds reveals a critical barrier: combining the incomplete solenoidal basis $\mathcal{L}^1$ with automated stencil selection triggers an $\mathcal{O}(1)$ error plateau in numerical curl evaluation.

Main Novel Contributions of this Work:

1. Resolution of Derivative Modal Aliasing: We demonstrate theoretically and numerically that while $\mathcal{L}^1$ converges on structured meshes, combining this incomplete solenoidal basis with automated stencil selection on arbitrary point clouds triggers an $\mathcal{O}(1)$ curl error plateau due to derivative modal aliasing (unrepresented normal derivatives leaking into rotational coefficients). Replacing $\mathcal{L}^1$ with the complete linear vector space $\mathcal{P}^1 = \mathcal{P}_1 \times \mathcal{P}_1$ restores all four components of the local Jacobian, eliminating stagnation and delivering consistent first-order ($\mathcal{O}(h)$) curl convergence.
2. Scale-Invariant Support Selection ($\widehat{\mathbf{A}}$ + k-d tree): We introduce a support qualification criterion based on a dimensionless local placement matrix $\widehat{\mathbf{A}}$. Normalizing by the local length scale eliminates the quartic $\mathcal{O}(h^4)$ determinant decay, preventing unphysical support dilation as $h \to 0$, unifying regular and irregular clouds under a transferable threshold ($\widehat{\mathrm{Tol}} = 0.80$), and bounding stencil conditioning under severe (25%) spatial-directional disorder.
3. Mathematical Demonstration of Global Non-Conformity: We prove that while VNMM exhibits an exact constructive equivalence to lowest-order Whitney 1-forms on conforming simplices, dynamically changing support stencils on point clouds produce a globally non-conforming approximation ($V_h \not\subset H(\mathbf{curl})$). The discrete approximation therefore does not inherit the exactness of the discrete de Rham complex, causing irrotational gradient nullspace modes to leak into the physical spectrum.
4. Variational Div-Curl Spectral Regularization: We incorporate a div-curl penalty weak formulation into the Ritz-Galerkin system, selectively stiffening non-physical gradient modes and shifting them outside the operational bandwidth.

Mandatory Author Declarations:

- This manuscript represents original research and has not been published previously, nor is it under consideration elsewhere.
- The submission has been approved by all co-authors and by the responsible authorities at the institutes where the work was carried out.
- The authors declare that they have no known competing financial interests or personal relationships that could have appeared to influence the work reported in this paper.

Thank you very much for your time and consideration of our work.

Sincerely yours,

Prof. Renato C. Mesquita (Corresponding Author)
Department of Electrical Engineering, Universidade Federal de Minas Gerais (UFMG)
Av. Antônio Carlos, 6627, Belo Horizonte, MG 31270-901, Brazil | E-mail: renato@ufmg.br